

Independent Mental Capacity Advocacy

Nottingham City and
Nottinghamshire



POhWER
Voices Heard • Lives Empowered

Your Voice, Your Choice



Independent Mental Capacity Advocacy (IMCA)

When someone cannot ask for an advocate themselves, because they do not have the capacity to do so due, for example, to brain injury, disability or illness, it does not mean that their views and wishes should not be taken into account.

People over the age of 16 who do not have an appropriate family member or friend to represent their views, may be entitled to an Independent Mental Capacity Advocate if they do not have capacity at the time to make decisions about serious medical treatment or a change of accommodation.

Our Independent Mental Capacity Advocates gather information about individuals referred to our service to help decision makers, such as doctors, to reach 'best interest' decisions about elements of their treatment and care.

Doctors, social workers and others involved in 'best interest' decisions can make a referral for IMCA (3rd party referrals).

Deprivation of Liberty Safeguards (DoLS)

Our DoLS advocates protect the human rights of people who have been admitted to hospital, or live in residential care, lack capacity (at the time) and it appears that they are being deprived of their liberty for their own safety. Our advocates work with them to ensure that their rights under the Mental Capacity Act are upheld and that the deprivation is lawful, proportionate and in their best interests.

The service is available to anyone over 18 who cannot understand the decisions being made about them and do not have family or friends who are appropriate or willing to help.

Referrals are made through the Local Authority.

Our service is free, confidential and independent.

How to get in touch



Email - imca@pohwer.net



Telephone - 0300 456 2370 (charged at local rate)



Minicom - 0300 456 2364



Text - send the word 'pohwer' with your name and number to 81025



Skype - pohwer.advocacy (8am to 6pm Monday to Friday)



Fax - 0300 456 2365



Post - PO Box 14043, Birmingham, B6 9BL



Website - www.pohwer.net



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Access to information

- We provide leaflets and information in a variety of languages and formats including Easy Read, audio and DVDs
- We have access to translation and interpreting services
- We use communication toolkits, Makaton and other signing techniques

